# Baby Simulator Roadmap

From the current prototypes (web sim, Blender render, and the "study with me" video cut) to the final project package due December 4.

Where I am now · Course deliverable · My working milestone

WEEK 5 · CLASS WED OCT 7

## Settle design questions

- Decide: multiple choice only, or let parents also type their own response
- Decide the baby's look: cartoon vs. human-like animation
- Decide how far players can customize scenarios
- Check technical limits (free-text parsing, animation effort, browser vs. Blender)

WEEK 6 · CLASS WED OCT 14

## Questionnaire + research

- Draft and send the parent questionnaire: scenarios where parents felt confused, and moments where they did a good job
- Gather evidence: parenting styles, common parenting harms, long-term effects of each style

WEEK 7 · CLASS WED OCT 21

## Midterm presentation DUE

- 3-minute talk: problem, concept, demo clip, early questionnaire findings, next steps
- Complete the "continue, start, pause" midterm reflection
- Rehearse twice against a timer

WEEK 8 · CLASS WED OCT 28

## Build the scenario engine

- Fold midterm feedback into the design
- For every scenario, write 5 answer choices, one per parenting style
- Map each choice to developmental factors that go up or down, differing by stage
- Build the first of the 4 stage versions as a playable care loop

WEEK 9 · CLASS WED NOV 4

## Test + memo draft 1 DUE

- Run 4–6 playtests with parents; record notes and short clips

- First version of the 500-word project memo

NOV 5–17 · NO CLASS NOV 11

## Expand to all 4 stages

- Build the remaining stage versions with their own scenario prompts
- Fix the top issues from testing

WEEK 10 · CLASS WED NOV 18

## Iterate + memo draft 2 DUE

- Create a scope map and share it in the design journal
- Add edge cases: twins or siblings (big and small age gaps, kids fighting, trade-offs between children)
- Add family structures: single parent, two moms, two dads, and how co-parents discuss decisions
- Second draft of the project memo

NOV 19 – DEC 1

## Final polish

- Final build and video export; organize project assets
- Draft the cover letter; keep Thanksgiving week light

WEEK 11 · CLASS WED DEC 2

## Final presentation DUE

- Short presentation plus live demo, with a recorded backup video
- Final draft of the project memo

FRI DEC 4 · 11:59 PM

## Submit final materials DUE

- Cover letter, project assets (sim, video, Blender files), final reflective memo

DEC 7–11

## Final 1:1 meeting

- 20-minute conversation about the work and course participation (scheduled in early November)

Dates follow the T550 2026 syllabus; each week is labeled by its Wednesday class.